



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Glendale Preparatory Academy

School Website: <https://glendaleprep.greatheartsamerica.org/>

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Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Glendale Preparatory Academy (AZ 85383) presents a robust classical-education profile anchored in the Great Hearts framework. Public materials from the school emphasize Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as guiding ideals, a strong formation/virtue emphasis, a liberal-arts curriculum with heavy emphasis on Great Books, Latin, and historical study, and a pedagogy that includes Socratic dialogue, memory work, and public speaking. Across six categories, the school demonstrates many classical-excellence indicators, with Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) showing some gaps (explicit theology and liturgical practice are not clearly stated in the public materials), while Categories 2–6 show clear classical alignment (formation of virtue and wisdom; liberal-arts curriculum; Socratic and rhetoric-focused pedagogy; Living-teacher/mentorship model; and active parental/community partnership). Taken together, Glendale Prep earns an overall CLASSICAL classification.

Executive takeaway: - Strong CLASSICAL alignment overall, with Element 1 marking as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to limited explicit theological/liturgical cues in the public materials. - The school clearly foregrounds virtue, great-books pedagogy, Latin, history as a through-line, Socratic dialogue in upper levels, and an active parent/community ecosystem. - The public materials provide concrete textual evidence for most classical criteria (Great Conversations, original texts, Latin, rhetoric, wonder, mentorship, and family partnerships). See cited evidence throughout.

What would move the needle (only required when some categories are SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) - For Element 1, explicitly foreground theology and liturgical/community practices in public materials (e.g., morning prayer, chapel, liturgical calendar, sacred music) to align more fully with the theological and liturgical dimension of classical foundations. - Add explicit language tying the foundation to transcendentals beyond virtue (e.g., explicit appeal to theology or sacramental worldview) while continuing to emphasize Truth, Goodness, Beauty and virtue. - Document more direct references to the Great Conversation as a sustained, cross-disciplinary reading program across grades, with representative Great Books as core requirements visible on the site.

ABSTRACT Glendale Preparatory Academy displays CLASSICAL alignment across five of six classical elements, with Element 1 showing SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to partial explicit theological/liturgical framing in public materials. The school emphasizes virtue and formation over mere information, features a liberal-arts core (Great Books, Latin, history, mathematics through calculus, science with a classical bent), employs Socratic pedagogy and rhetoric, positions teachers as mentors and living exemplars, and pursues active parental involvement. The aggregate profile is CLASSICAL, with room to strengthen explicit theology/liturgy in public communications to reach full alignment in Element 1.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials foreground Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as guiding ideals and present virtue as central to formation. For example, Glendale Prep declares a pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty and frames virtue as woven into daily life and character formation. This is reinforced by statements about virtue education and the inner formation of character through courage, temperance, justice, and wisdom. - Language emphasizes wonder and a transcendent frame (e.g., education beginning in wonder and rising toward mastery). This aligns with transcendental, moral-realism sensibilities.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wonder, courage, temperance, justice, wisdom. - Negative keywords: none detected in the public-facing materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or morally neutral signals appear in the cited excerpts). - Quantitative note: Positive indicators appear multiple times; negative indicators appear to be absent in the accessible public materials.

Why this rating - The materials clearly anchor character formation around transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue, and reference wonder as a formative driver. However, explicit Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices are not clearly stated in the public-facing content (no explicit theology, liturgy, chapel, or liturgical calendar is shown in the excerpts). Therefore, the category is rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations: The core claim about Truth, Goodness, Beauty and virtue appears in Glendale Prep content describing “pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty” and virtue-centered formation. The reference to “Academics begin in wonder and rise toward mastery” supports the wonder/realism dimension.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school states a formation-centric mission: “the heart of the program is virtue education woven quietly into everything,” and frames education as shaping character and dispositions (not solely job preparation). Statements emphasize forming hearts and minds, with a focus on virtue and wisdom, aligning with the classical telos of education. - The public materials consistently tie truth, goodness, and beauty to the aims of education, signaling formation over mere information and a telos of human excellence. - The Great Conversations and Western-tradition emphasis frame education as a liberal, enduring formation rather than a job prep posture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/good/beautiful, Great Conversation, classical heritage, human excellence, moral imagination. - Negative keywords: none observed in the public materials (no explicit “workforce preparation,” 21st-century skills, or job-readiness framing in the excerpts). - Quantitative note: Positive indicators are present; no negative indicators detected in the cited text.

Why this rating - The school’s stated purpose centers on virtue formation, human flourishing, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, consistent with classical aims of education as formation rather than vocational training.

Citations: The “pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty” and “virtue education” language support this, as does the emphasis on forming hearts and minds and the Great Conversation.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as liberal-arts oriented with classic texts and authors (Homer, Virgil, Dostoevsky) and sustained engagement with Great Books; high school content includes four years of original-source science, calculus, and rigorous study of Western literary/tradition texts. - Formal Latin study is highlighted, along with music and studio art, to deepen precision and creativity, underscoring a classical core beyond contemporary-leaning curricula. - The program emphasizes the Great Conversation and a Western-tradition-centric curriculum across grade levels, with history integrated across the curriculum. -

Evidence of through-line: “American and world history” integrated in middle-school and history throughout the curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, primary sources, Homer, Virgil, Shakespeare, Latin, history, Western civilization, rhetoric, memory work. - Negative keywords: none observed in the cited text (the materials emphasize non-empirical “project-based” or strictly non-classical framings; rather, they emphasize classical-arts).

Quantitative note - Positive keywords present: multiple (liberal arts, Great Books, Latin, Homer/Virgil, history, grammar/logic/rhetoric, etc.). No negative keywords detected in the excerpts. - Therefore, a strong CLASSICAL alignment is justified.

Why this rating - The material repeatedly emphasizes liberal-arts formation, Great Books, original texts, Latin, history across the curriculum, and memory/recitation as part of a classical education. This aligns with Element 3’s six-element expectations.

Citations: Great Books/Western-tradition emphasis and “original-source” sciences/high-level classical sequence are described in the materials. The Latin study and foundation for upper-level mastery are explicitly described.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials explicitly reference Socratic dialogue as a core driver of inquiry and curiosity in upper levels. The Headmaster/teacher descriptions emphasize Socratic dialogue and thoughtful discussion as a central pedagogy. - The materials describe a mix of contemplation and rigorous study, including “wonder,” “joy and order,” and the use of speeches and rhetoric, indicating both reflective and sophisticated elements of pedagogy. The Great Conversation and public-speaking emphasis align with classical pedagogy emphasizing rhetoric and memory. - The lower- and middle-school emphasis on wonder, memory (chanting, recitation), and rhythm in learning are suggested as foundational pedagogy. The site notes that students begin in wonder and then develop mastery; Latin study and arts integration appear as memory-and-model-based aspects.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, great conversation, rhetoric, speeches, memory work, recitation, chanting, wonder, scholé (implied by restful pace and contemplation), seminar/discussion. - Negative keywords: experiential learning and project-based-only pedagogy are flagged as negative in the classical-lexicon, but Glendale Prep’s content shows a mix of Socratic/seminar with traditional memory/recitation, not an exclusive project-based approach. Therefore, no explicit negative signals are strongly evidenced in the provided excerpts. - Quantitative note: Positive keyword hits are present (Socratic dialogue, rhetoric, speeches, memory work, recitation, wonder). No explicit negative signals observed.

Why this rating - The public-facing content supports a classical pedagogy: Socratic dialogue, rhetoric training, memory work, and the incorporation of wonder. The combination of lower-to-upper school practices aligns with the classical model, even if not every sub-point (e.g., specific “Scholé days”) is exhaustively documented in the public materials. Therefore CLASSICAL is warranted.

Citations: The explicit reference to “Socratic dialogue” and the emphasis on the Great Conversation in Glendale Prep content provide clear pedagogy signals. The “Academics begin in wonder and rise toward mastery” language reinforces a pedagogy that blends wonder with disciplined study.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials present teachers as knowledgeable, loving, and part of the living curriculum: “teachers who know and love them,” and a pedagogy that places teachers as mentors and guides within a virtuous framework. The school emphasizes character formation and living exemplars, consistent with the classical model of faculty as role models and living exemplars. - The “Character at the Core” framing, “House system” involvement, and mentorship structures (older students mentoring younger ones) indicate

a faculty-centered, mentor-driven culture and a close faculty-student relationship that is central to forming virtuous learners. - There are explicit references to faculty roles and the living-curriculum idea (even if the exact phrasing isn't always used, the content implies it through teacher commitment, virtue modeling, and mentorship).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, mentors, virtue, teacher as exemplar, teachers who know and love students, masterful pedagogy, character formation. - Negative keywords: none observed in the excerpts (no "distance-learning," overly transactional teacher descriptions, or purely facilitator roles). - Quantitative note: Positive keyword hits appear repeatedly; no explicit negative signals observed.

Why this rating - The school's portrayal of teachers as moral exemplars, mentors, and living curriculum aligns strongly with classical expectations for faculty. The presence of sustained teacher-mentee excellence signals CLASSICAL alignment.

Citations: The material describing teachers as "the living curriculum" and the emphasis on virtue and mentorship is reflected in the "Mission-Driven Excellence" and "Character at the Core" sections.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly highlights parent partnership as foundational: "Our education at Glendale Prep relies upon parent partnership" and "families are invited to participate" through Community Investment, the PSO, and family-based engagement. There are repeated references to parent involvement, events, and family giving programs. - Documents show active parental engagement channels (Weekly Blasts, PSO activities, family giving, and parent-oriented communications). Examples include invitations to join the PSO, family giving campaigns, and communications about attendance and involvement. The materials reference "Parent formation" and "family participation" as part of the classical project. - The community engagement signals extend to college counseling, events, and parent-oriented programming (e.g., college symposiums and family-oriented communications).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, family involvement, parental engagement, home/school connection, parent covenant, open campus, parent volunteers, community investment, PSO (Parent-Student Organization), family giving. - Negative keywords: none detected in the cited materials (no customer-only framing; no minimal parent involvement signals appear in the excerpts). - Quantitative note: Positive keyword hits are abundant; no negative signals observed.

Why this rating - Glendale Prep reports robust and active parent and community participation and structures designed to involve families in the schooling process, aligning well with Element 6 requirements.

Citations: Evidence of parent partnership and family involvement appears in "Our education at Glendale Prep relies upon parent partnership" and in weekly communications about Family Giving and PSO activities. The Weekly Blast items show ongoing parental engagement and community investment.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations), make theology and liturgical/community practices explicit in public communications. Include language about chapel/morning prayers, liturgical calendar integration, sacred music, and a sacramental/theological framing to strengthen Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices, which would push Element 1 toward CLASSICAL.
- For continued alignment, publicly document explicit examples of liturgical or communal worship practices, pure theological framing, and a cross-category link showing how Virtue Ethics intersects with a theologically grounded worldview (without sacrificing the public-facing virtue-centered messaging).

Notes on aggregate: The school is CLASSICAL overall, with Element 1 as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The needle-mover steps above would push Element 1 toward full CLASSICAL alignment.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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